

Defect Tracker (Template)

Step 5 · Experimentation

Tracks defects found during build and UAT: what broke, how bad, who owns it, and whether it shipped or got deferred. Distinct from the RAID log, a defect is a specific, reproducible problem with the solution itself, not a risk, assumption, issue, or dependency around the project.

How to use this

Log a defect the moment it's found, during build testing or UAT, whichever comes first. Severity should reflect user impact, not how hard the fix is: a rare but data-corrupting bug outranks a common but cosmetic one. Every defect gets a disposition before the sprint closes, fixed, deferred with a named reason, or accepted as a known limitation, "still investigating" is not a disposition.

Severity definitions

Severity	Definition
Critical	Blocks core functionality or produces incorrect results with real consequences. Cannot ship with this open.
High	Significant impact on a common path; workaround exists but is costly.
Medium	Impacts an edge case or has an easy workaround.
Low	Cosmetic, or affects a rarely used path.

Defect log

ID	Description	Severity	Found	Owner	Status
[D-01]	[What broke, and the steps to reproduce it]	[Crit/High/Med/Low]	[Sprint #]	[Name]	[Open/Fixed/Deferred]
[D-02]	[...]	[...]	[...]	[...]	[...]
[D-03]	[...]	[...]	[...]	[...]	[...]
[D-04]	[...]	[...]	[...]	[...]	[...]

If "Deferred" is the disposition, capture why (in a Notes column, or the RAID log if it has downstream risk) so it doesn't resurface as a surprise after launch.

Sourced from the AIFT Playbook.